

VZT1

Marketing Applications

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A marketing manager drafting her company's first marketing plan, who is also the company's longest-serving employee, has already chosen a 30% discount promotion but has not analyzed the market or set objectives. What step should come first?

- A. Choose advertising channels.
- B. Finalize pricing tactics like the discount.
- C. A situation analysis of the market, customers, competitors, and the company.
- D. Rely on her long experience in place of analysis.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A regional bank focuses on small-business owners in three counties and wants them to see it as “the bank that answers the phone on the first ring.” The bank's lobby was renovated last year. Which step does the phrase represent?

- A. Segmentation.
- B. Positioning.
- C. Targeting.
- D. A product decision about the renovated lobby.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A company decides to sell its premium headphones only through its own website and three flagship stores, not through big-box retailers. The headphones come in four colors. Which of the four Ps is being decided?

- A. Promotion.
- B. Product.
- C. Price.
- D. Place.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A retailer buys jackets for \$60 each and wants a 40% gross margin on the selling price. The jackets are made from recycled materials. What should the selling price be?

- A. \$150
- B. \$100
- C. \$84
- D. \$36

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A product sells for \$80 with a gross margin of 25%. What is its cost?

- A. \$60
- B. \$64
- C. \$100
- D. \$20

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A streaming service raises its monthly price 10%, and subscriptions fall 25%. It also just launched a new logo. What is the price elasticity of demand, and what happened to revenue?

- A. -2.5 ; demand is elastic, so revenue fell.
- B. -25%
- C. -2.5 ; demand is elastic, so revenue rose.
- D. -0.4 ; demand is inelastic, so revenue rose.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Demand for a product has a price elasticity of -0.5 . The firm raises its price 8%. About how much does quantity demanded change?

- A. -8%
- B. -16%
- C. -4%
- D. $+4\%$

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A fitness-tracker brand's sales growth has flattened, competitors match its features, and prices are falling. The brand's ads feature a famous mountain trail. Which strategy fits this life-cycle stage?

- A. Decline: withdraw the product immediately.
- B. Introduction: build basic awareness with heavy education.
- C. Growth: expand distribution rapidly.
- D. Maturity: defend share through differentiation, new uses, and cost efficiency.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A snack maker spends heavily on TV and social media ads so that shoppers will ask stores to carry its new chips. The company's CEO appears in the ads. Which promotion strategy is this?

- A. Push, because the CEO is in the ads.
- B. Push strategy.
- C. Pull strategy.
- D. Personal selling.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which tactic is part of a push strategy?

- A. Handing out free samples to shoppers.
- B. Running an influencer campaign.
- C. Offering coupons to consumers on social media.
- D. Giving retailers trade discounts and slotting allowances to stock the product.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A luxury watchmaker allows only one authorized dealer per metropolitan area to sell its watches. The brand was founded in 1890. What distribution intensity is this?

- A. Exclusive distribution.
- B. Intensive distribution.
- C. Direct distribution only.
- D. Selective distribution.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which product is best suited to intensive distribution?

- A.** Mid-range kitchen appliances.
- B.** Bottled water.
- C.** Any product, since more outlets always mean more profit.
- D.** Luxury sports cars.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A marketing manager drafting her company's first marketing plan, ~~who is also the company's longest-serving employee~~, has already chosen a 30% discount promotion but has not analyzed the market or set objectives. What step should come first?

Target word: first planning step **Decides:** No analysis or objectives yet.

A	Adjacent category	A promotion decision within the mix, which comes later.
B	Inverted operation	Tactics come after analysis and objectives.
C	Correct	Analysis grounds every later decision.
D	Camouflage	Tenure does not replace market analysis.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A regional bank focuses on small-business owners in three counties and wants them to see it as “the bank that answers the phone on the first ring.” ~~The bank's lobby was renovated last year.~~ Which step does the phrase represent?

Target word: STP step **Decides:** A desired image in customers' minds.

A	Confusion set	Segmentation divides the market into groups.
B	Correct	Positioning defines the distinct image.
C	Adjacent category	Choosing small-business owners was targeting.
D	Camouflage	The lobby is not what the phrase describes.

3. Answer D Concept 3

A company decides to sell its premium headphones only through its own website and three flagship stores, not through big-box retailers. ~~The headphones come in four colors.~~ Which of the four Ps is being decided?

Target word: which P **Decides:** Where the product is sold.

A	Confusion set	Promotion is communication.
B	Camouflage	Color options are product, but they are not the decision here.
C	Adjacent category	“Premium” hints at price, but no price was set.
D	Correct	Channel and outlet choices are place.

4. Answer B Concept 4

A retailer buys jackets for \$60 each and wants a 40% gross margin on the selling price. ~~The jackets are made from recycled materials.~~ What should the selling price be?

Target word: price for a target margin **Decides:** Price = cost / (1 – margin).

A	Dropped element	Divides by 0.40, dropping the “1 –”.
B	Correct	$\$60 / 0.60 = \100 ; margin = $\$40 / \$100 = 40\%$.
C	Confusion set	A 40% markup on cost gives only about a 29% margin.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies cost by 0.60, below cost.

5. Answer A Concept 4 • transfer

A product sells for \$80 with a gross margin of 25%. What is its cost?

Target word: solve for cost **Decides:** Cost = price $\times$ (1 – margin).

A	Correct	$\$80 \times 0.75 = \60 .
B	Confusion set	Treats 25% as a markup on cost ($\$80 / 1.25$).
C	Inverted operation	Multiplies price by 1.25.
D	Adjacent category	That is the margin in dollars.

6. Answer A Concept 5

A streaming service raises its monthly price 10%, and subscriptions fall 25%. ~~It also just launched a new logo.~~ What is the price elasticity of demand, and what happened to revenue?

Target word: elasticity and revenue effect **Decides:** $-25\% / +10\%$.

A	Correct	Revenue = $1.10 \times 0.75 = 0.825$ of before.
B	Wrong stem number	That is the quantity change, not elasticity.
C	Confusion set	With elastic demand, a price rise lowers revenue.
D	Inverted operation	Divides price change by quantity change.

7. Answer C Concept 5 • transfer

Demand for a product has a price elasticity of -0.5 . The firm raises its price 8%. About how much does quantity demanded change?

Target word: solve for quantity change **Decides:** % change in Q = elasticity $\times$ % change in P.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the price change.
B	Inverted operation	Divides by 0.5 instead of multiplying.
C	Correct	$-0.5 \times 8\% = -4\%$.
D	Confusion set	Sign error; a price increase lowers quantity demanded.

8. Answer D Concept 6

A fitness-tracker brand's sales growth has flattened, competitors match its features, and prices are falling. ~~The brand's ads feature a famous mountain trail.~~ Which strategy fits this life-cycle stage?

Target word: stage and strategy **Decides:** Flat sales, feature parity, price pressure = maturity.

A	Absolute language	Sales are flat, not falling away.
B	Adjacent category	The product is already well known.
C	Confusion set	Growth has already flattened.
D	Correct	Fits a saturated, competitive stage.

9. Answer C Concept 7

A snack maker spends heavily on TV and social media ads so that shoppers will ask stores to carry its new chips. ~~The company's CEO appears in the ads.~~ Which promotion strategy is this?

Target word: push or pull **Decides:** Promotion aimed at end consumers.

A	Camouflage	Who appears in ads does not decide push vs. pull.
B	Inverted operation	Push targets channel members.
C	Correct	Consumer demand pulls the product through the channel.
D	Adjacent category	A promotion tool, not the strategy described.

10. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

Which tactic is part of a push strategy?

Target word: work backward from strategy to tactic **Decides:** Push targets the channel.

A	Adjacent category	Consumer sales promotion: pull.
B	Confusion set	Builds consumer demand: pull.
C	Inverted operation	Aimed at consumers: pull.
D	Correct	Incentives aimed at channel members.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A luxury watchmaker allows only one authorized dealer per metropolitan area to sell its watches. ~~The brand was founded in 1890.~~ What distribution intensity is this?

Target word: distribution intensity **Decides:** One dealer per area.

A	Correct	One outlet per area protects brand image.
B	Inverted operation	Intensive uses as many outlets as possible.
C	Confusion set	Dealers are intermediaries, so it is not direct.
D	Adjacent category	Selective uses several chosen outlets.

12. Answer B Concept 8 • transfer

Which product is best suited to intensive distribution?

Target word: work backward from intensity to product **Decides:** Low-cost convenience goods.

A	Adjacent category	Shopping goods suit selective distribution.
B	Correct	Convenience goods need maximum availability.
C	Absolute language	Wide distribution can dilute brands and raise costs.
D	Inverted operation	Suited to exclusive distribution.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	1	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	9	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	2	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Marketing planning sequence	Situation analysis comes first, then objectives, then segmentation, targeting, and positioning, then the marketing mix, then implementation and control.	Jumping straight to tactics like discounts or ad channels.	A tactic chosen before any analysis.
2	Segmentation, targeting, positioning	Segmentation divides the market; targeting chooses segments; positioning sets the distinct image in target customers' minds.	Calling a positioning statement targeting.	"Wants them to see it as..."
3	The four Ps	Product = what is offered; price = what is charged; place = where and how it reaches customers; promotion = how it is communicated.	Classifying a channel decision as product or price.	A decision about where something is sold.
4	Margin vs. markup	Price for a target margin on price = cost / (1 – margin); markup on cost = cost × (1 + markup).	Using markup math when margin is asked.	"Margin on the selling price."
5	Price elasticity of demand	Elasticity = % change in quantity / % change in price; above 1 in absolute value is elastic, and raising price lowers revenue.	Flipping the ratio or the revenue effect.	A percent price change and a percent quantity change.
6	Product life cycle strategy	Introduction: build awareness; growth: expand; maturity: defend share, differentiate, cut cost; decline: harvest or divest.	Using growth or decline tactics in maturity.	Flat sales, feature matching, falling prices.
7	Push vs. pull promotion	Push promotes to channel members to stock and sell the product; pull promotes to end consumers so they demand it.	Calling consumer advertising push.	Who the promotion is aimed at.
8	Distribution intensity	Intensive = as many outlets as possible (convenience goods); selective = some outlets (shopping goods); exclusive = one or very few (luxury or specialty).	Mixing up selective and exclusive.	How many outlets per area.

Course scope (public description): Marketing Applications allows students to apply their knowledge of core marketing principles by creating a comprehensive marketing plan. The plan will apply knowledge of the marketing planning process, market analysis, and the marketing mix (product, place, promotion, and price).